Behaviour for Learning

Basic Expectations

What is.....

Behaviour for Learning (BfL) refers to the attitudes, actions, and habits that support effective learning in the classroom. It focuses on:

1. **Positive Student Behaviours**: encouraging respect, focus, and responsibility.
2. **Creating a Learning-Focused Environment**: establishing clear rules and routines to minimize distractions.
3. **Building Strong Relationships**: promoting mutual respect between teachers and students.
4. **Developing Skills for Success**: helping students become independent, self-regulated learners.

BfL is about more than just following rules; it's about fostering the behaviours that enable students to engage fully and achieve their best in a supportive environment.

BASIC EXPECTATIONS	
Behaviour for Learning (BFL)	
BFL1	When the observer enters the classroom, the atmosphere in the classroom is already calm and purposeful.
BFL2	Teacher uses the Lesson Start Mantra (5-Peacefulness, 4-Diligence, 3-Determination, 2-Scan, 1-Pause)
BFL3	Pupils are focused on the task, whether that is attentive to the teacher or independent work.
BFL4	Teacher pauses to allow pupils to comply, scans the room to ensure 100% attention before giving instructions.
BFL5	Teacher provides clear instructions in order, no more than 3-step instructions.
BFL6	When the teacher gives an instruction, the pupils follow this first time.
BFL7	Pupils do not leave seats without permission, expectation of needing to leave seat is clear.
BFL8	If attention, further participation/engagement is required, teacher uses the 'Diligence' mantra and returns to a strong position in the classroom. This indicates 'pens/pencil down, arms/hands folded, sit upright & eyes on me'.
BFL9	Behaviour is managed through positioning, proximity and resetting expectations where required.

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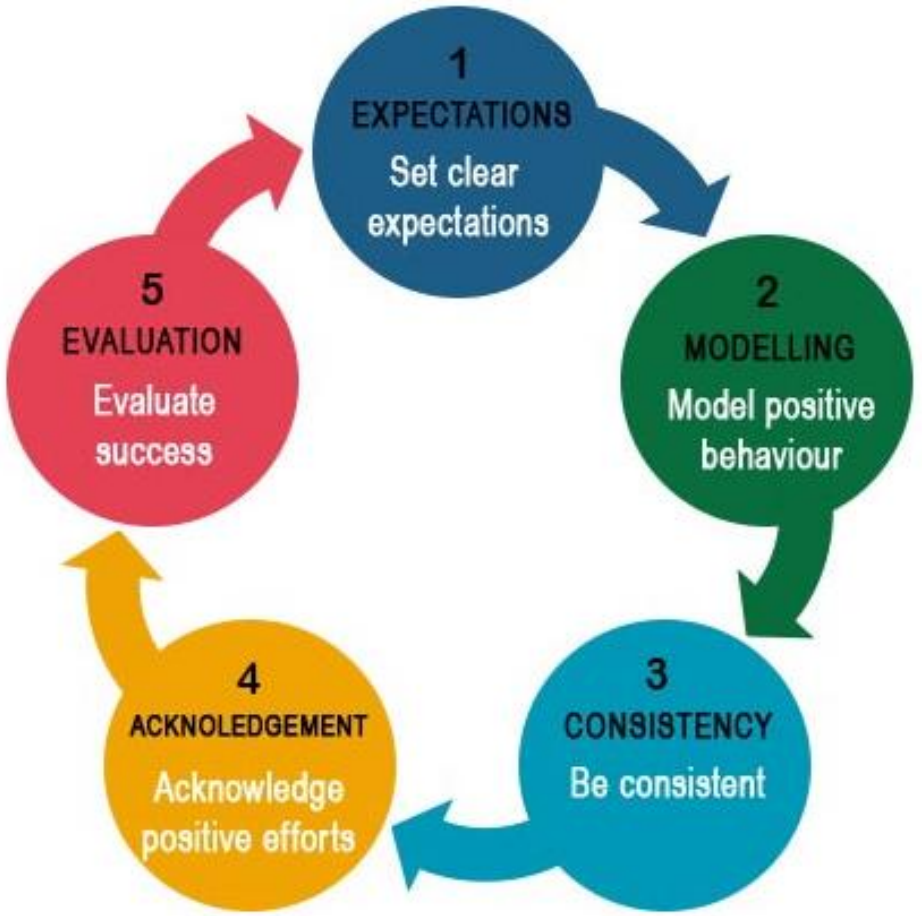
A classroom is only a room – but roll out the right routines and it becomes a place where students' minds can soar.
Get Better Faster, Paul Bambrick-Santoyo



Five-steps of implementing PBS

Spotlight on.....

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The Research...

1. **Cognitive Load Theory** - *Sweller (1988)*

- Mantras reduce cognitive demand by creating predictable routines.
- Pupils conserve working memory for learning rather than decoding behaviour expectations.

2. **Behavioural Consistency** - *Lemov, Teach Like a Champion*

- Repeated phrases establish clarity and consistency, reducing ambiguity in instructions.
- Builds a culture of calm focus and self-regulation.

3. **Self-Regulation and Mindset** - *Dweck (2006), Zimmerman & Schunk (2001)*

- Positive affirmations help pupils internalise a growth mindset and practice self-talk.
- Encourages pupils to anchor themselves in productive behaviours during transitions or moments of stress.

The impact...

- Creates **calm, focused** learning environments.
- **Minimises** need for **repeated** instructions.
- Helps pupils feel psychologically safe through **predictable structure.**
- Empowers pupils with internal scripts for **attention, resilience, and learning.**

The implementation...

- Ensure you are familiar and well-practised in using the mantra. Rehearse individually, in your team or with your so you feel secure in using it with the class.
- **Practise step-by-step and repeatedly with your new class to ensure all pupils are familiar with each step of the mantra and what it means for them**.
- Use the full mantra consistently at the <u>start of every lesson</u>**.** This helps you, the pupils and any cover staff.
- **Use 'peacefulness' and 'diligence' to control volume and focus consistently throughout the school day.**

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The Research...

The EEF (Education Endowment Fund):

Cognitive load refers to how much working memory is used when asked to process information or a task.

The working memory has a limited capacity and can become overloaded.

When students are required to process information that is in two or more different spaces (visually or verbally) then then cognitive overload can occur. This results in split attention and students not being able to fulfil the task or instruction fully.

The impact...
(WMI) What happens when students are attentive?

- Improved Focus and Engagement
- Better Memory and Retention
- Increased Participation
- Establishes a virtuous cycle with an improved teacher response
- Improved classroom atmosphere
- Higher academic performance
- Signals respect and readiness

The implementation...

- Ensure your instructions are always clear and concise (be clear of what you want to say before you begin).
- **Set clear expectations from the start when asking pupils to pay attention to you or focus on a task. Practise repeatedly until pupils are secure.**
- Use the mantras 'peacefulness', 'diligence ', 'pens down eyes on me' to support this.
- **Deliver from a central position in the classroom and in a strong voice (formal tone, stand still, speak with purpose)**
- Only move forward with your instruction when you have <u>every child's</u> full attention.
- Re-enforce with positive praise.
- **Re-set expectations whenever you need to.**

Key Messages....

Use the mantras consistently for long-term success

No split-attention

Set clear expectations from the start

Next steps

- ✓ Review the checklist thoroughly
- ✓ Embed the checklist routines with your new class as soon as they return
- ✓ Coaches will drop-in to lessons over the next week
- ✓ If you have any questions about embedding these routines, speak to your coach – they will be happy to discuss and offer the opportunity to rehearse with you

When a teacher doesn't know with absolute clarity, inside and out, what a routine should look like when the students are doing it properly, there's no way to get the students to match the vision. That's why writing up and rehearsing the routine is the starting point to getting it right – Paul Bambrick-Santoyo (Get Better Faster)